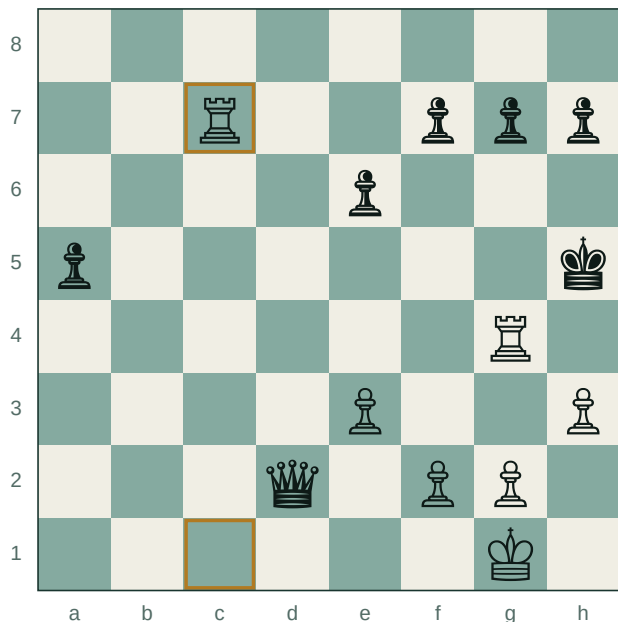


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 33

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 33.Rc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33...Qd1+ 34. Kh2 Qd6+ 35. g3 Qxc7

33...Qd1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From d1 it attacks king on g1 and rook on g4. Recorded reply: **34.Kh2**.

34...Qd6+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. From d6 it attacks king on h2 and rook on c7. Recorded reply: **35.g3**.

35...Qxc7 The queen captures the rook on c7.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on c7. Check for tactical protection.